6 Things to Consider

When Installing EV Chargers in Apartment Societies

A practical checklist for RWAs, facility managers, and residents

PRACTICAL GUIDE

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Introduction

Installing EV chargers in apartment complexes requires careful planning. Unlike a standalone home, apartments involve shared electrical infrastructure, common area decisions, and multiple stakeholders. This guide covers the six most important considerations.

1. Electrical Capacity and Load Assessment

Before installing any charger, assess your apartment's electrical capacity. Key questions: What is the total sanctioned load for the building? How much spare capacity is available on the common supply? Is there a separate meter for common area electricity? Can individual flat meters support additional EV charging load?

For individual charger installations (one per flat), the load is drawn from the flat owner's meter. This is the simplest approach requiring only a 3.3 kW or 7.4 kW charger per parking bay.

For shared or common chargers, the load comes from the society's common supply. This requires RWA approval and a clear billing mechanism.

2. Ownership Model: Individual vs Shared

Individual Ownership

Each flat owner installs their own charger at their designated parking bay, connected to their flat's electricity meter. Simpler for billing (the flat owner pays directly) but requires each owner to manage their own charger.

Shared / Society-Owned

The RWA or building management installs chargers in common parking areas, connected to the society's common meter. This requires a billing and cost recovery mechanism. RIOD's Community Charging Suite provides a ready-made solution for this.

3. Billing and Cost Recovery

This is often the biggest concern for apartment societies.

Using Community Charging Suite (Recommended)

RIOD's free platform handles all billing automatically. Each charging session is metered, billed at the configured tariff, and credited to the charger owner's wallet. Users pay via the app. No manual meter reading, no disputes, no spreadsheets. The platform charges only a 10% service fee on in-app transactions.

Flat-Rate Monthly Fee

Charge a fixed monthly fee per EV owner. Simple but not usage-based, which can feel unfair.

Sub-Metering

Install a sub-meter per charger and bill based on actual kWh consumed. Accurate but requires manual reading and billing effort.

4. Parking Bay Allocation and Cable Routing

- Identify which parking bays are closest to the electrical supply (shorter cable runs = lower cost)
- Plan cable routing to avoid tripping hazards and aesthetic issues
- Wall-mounted chargers (POWERPOD Lite, Go) need a wall or pillar adjacent to the parking bay
- For open parking without walls, consider POWERPOD City with pedestal mounting

- Reserve future-ready bays by running conduit pipes during initial installation

5. RWA Approvals and Resident Buy-In

- Present a clear proposal with costs, benefits, and a pilot plan
- Address common concerns: safety, electrical load, fire risk, and fairness
- Start with a small pilot (2-3 chargers) to demonstrate feasibility
- Highlight that AC chargers (3.3 kW to 22 kW) draw moderate power and do not pose fire risks when installed by certified electricians
- Show the billing solution (Community Charging Suite) to address cost-sharing concerns
- Get sign-off from the electrical engineer or consultant who manages the building's electrical system

6. Choosing the Right Charger

Individual Parking (Own Meter)

POWERPOD Lite 3.3 kW or 7.4 kW. Simple, affordable, no connectivity needed since billing is on your own meter.

Shared/Common Charger

POWERPOD Go 7.4 kW. Wi-Fi connectivity, OCPP 1.6J, and RFID authentication enable integration with Community Charging Suite for automated billing and access control.

High-Demand Society Parking

POWERPOD City 7.4 kW or 22 kW. Dual connectors for high-traffic shared areas, pedestal mount for open parking.

Summary Checklist

1. Assess electrical capacity and spare load
2. Decide individual vs shared ownership model
3. Set up billing and cost recovery (use Community Charging Suite for shared chargers)
4. Plan parking bay allocation and cable routing
5. Get RWA approval with a clear proposal
6. Choose the right POWERPOD model for your setup

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